Letters from the Chairs

Dear Delegates,

Actors and playwrights have been educating and entertaining humans since the beginning of humanity, and serve as a staple, stable piece of international culture and exchange. Hollywood, one of the most prominent cultural forces in the twentieth century, influenced everything from art to fashion to Communism.

My name is Eila Ganel, and I'm a junior at Canyon Crest Academy. I've been in Model UN since my freshman year, and serve on the executive board as Secretary. I've had experience at six different conferences over my three years at CCA MUN, and chaired at last year's inaugural conference, RavenMUN I. Outside of MUN, I like to swim, hang out with my dogs, and write unfunny movie reviews on Letterboxd.

We sincerely intend for this committee to be fun and for delegates to keep an open mind to twists and turns as the topic progresses. Therefore, we encourage all delegates to refrain from questioning certain historical accuracies in the pursuit of absolving difficult issues with creative solutions. Preparation should also then be focused on the delegate's own person and role in the issue, as well as big-picture concepts behind topics discussed.

Eila Ganel

Co-Chair of RavenMUN II: The Hollywood Scare

Hello Delegates!

My name is Katrina Jensen and I am honored to serve as one of your chairs for Lights, Camera, Accusations: The Red Scare in Hollywood. This committee is incredibly interesting to me as it takes place at a critical time in the United States for our current understanding of free speech and the political expectations for celebrities. This committee has a unique challenge before it considering we will have two opposing viewpoints given an intense, time-sensitive, challenge. With the fast-paced nature of this committee, I am excited to hear what you all have to say.

A bit about me, I am a senior at Canyon Crest Academy planning to major in architecture. I have been in Model UN for three years and this is my second year helping with RavenMUN. In my free time, I enjoy painting, volunteering at my local aquarium, and baking.

This committee has a unique structure due to its fast pace and inherent secrecy. Some of the delegates, for example, will be undercover CIA or KGB agents. Tread with caution, be careful which delegates you trust, and keep an eye out for 'unAmerican activity'. I'm looking forward to seeing this committee unfold.

Kat Jensen

Co-Chair of RavenMUN II: The Hollywood Scare

Background Information

Post WW2 Tensions

While the U.S. and U.S.S.R were allied during World War II, post war relations quickly degraded. A large element to the rift between the two nations was a struggle for global power after World War II. By the end of the war, the United States was set to become a global economic and political powerhouse, being one of few nations that exited the war economically stable. However, the Soviet Union still held political power after the war, especially in deciding what to do with Central Europe in the aftermath of the conflict. Beginning in the division of Germany immediately after the war and continuing through the next several decades, the Soviet Union maintained a buffer from Western Europe in the form of several Eastern European nations. Beyond Europe, the communist ideologies held by the Soviet Union spread through Asia, Africa, and South America. This was of great concern to the United States, which adopted a policy of containment regarding communism, built around the belief that if allowed to spread, communism would eventually control the globe and harm American interests.

Despite the name, the Cold War was not free of conflict, however: that conflict took place in the form of proxy-wars. Proxy-wars were conflicts between two nations that are not officially involved in the war, but do supply aid to either side of the war. Between 1945 and 1960, the United Kingdom and other European powers were relinquishing power over their colonies in Africa and Asia. In the American perspective, these newly independent territories were at risk of being swallowed up by the Soviet Union, and therefore, the United States had to respond by sending aid to several newly independent nations in order to build a connection with the U.S.

before developing a connection with the Soviet Union. The U.S.S.R also competed with the U.S. to gain influence over the young nations, resulting in a competition of aid and support.

In 1950, North Korea invaded South Korea. North Korea, being a communist force, was supported by the U.S.S.R while capitalist South Korea was supported by the U.S. Chinese forces later joined those of North Korea. This war was a means for both the U.S. and the U.S.S.R to intimidate and display their military prowess without actually declaring war on each other. The Korean war had no official ending, with a ceasefire being what holds the current border. In 1954, Vietnam gained independence from France, causing a split in the new nation and setting up the Vietnam war in the 1960s. Tensions immediately after World War II were defined by a struggle over geopolitical dominance between two opposing governing systems. This tension was manifested physically, through diplomatic action and spy activity, and through propaganda.

The Advent of Communism in Russia and the Formation of the Eastern Bloc

Modern communism as a social, political, and economic mechanism proliferated in Russia and Eastern Europe starting in the nineteenth century. Communism defines a classless society in which production and manufacturing processes are controlled and owned by the public, and divisions between social groups - for instance, salary and benefits - varies from little to obsolete. Similarly, a system under socialism also ideally reduces inequality underneath collective ownership, but incorporates concepts of democracy and, to some extent, private ownership. Both of these concepts are widely associated with the works of German-Jewish writer Karl Marx, including his infamous 1848 political pamphlet *The Communist Manifesto*.

Different forms of communism have been prevalent throughout history, but the general concept is inspired by the exploitative relationship between the working class (the proletariat)

and the owning class (the bourgeoisie). In the early twentieth century, Russia's population largely consisted of impoverished, illiterate peasants. The 1917 Russian Revolution of Vladimir Lenin's Bolsheviks first parked conversation about communism on a wide stage. The Bolsheviks held a majority in the All-Russian Congress of Soviets under the Russian Provisional Government, which set up a series of socialist reforms and support of Vladimir Lenin's movement. The Bolsheviks gained power after the Russian Provisional Government was unable to draft a constitution, conduct social and land reform, and withdraw from World War I, but subsequently initiated the Russian Civil War (1917-1922) with opposing political parties battling for control. The Red Terror occurred during this period: a campaign of mass executions, arrests, and political repression of the elite class conducted by the Bolsheviks. A long, gruesome conflict ensued, concluding with power consolidated under the Bolsheviks (Red Army) and the newly-established Soviet Union (USSR).

Communist states played a key role in World War II; the Soviet Union was initially allied with Nazi Germany and its Axis powers bloc, but later joined the Allied forces after Hitler's invasion of Russia in 1941. After the war, the influence of the Soviet Union expanded to other governments in Eastern Europe, such as Poland and Yugoslavia. Amidst the arms and space race, an Iron Curtain was drawn across Europe. The Iron Curtain was an ideological and physical boundary that divided Europe into two opposing halves: Soviet-affiliated, communist Eastern Europe and democratic Western Europe. The Eastern Bloc represented the geographically right portion of this half: it was an unofficial coalition of communist states, including East Germany, Czechoslovakia, Hungary, and Poland.

Political Divide and Proxy Warfare

After the establishment of the Eastern bloc and the Iron Curtain, the political and ideological divide between democratic capitalism and authoritarian communism grew deeper and spread farther. Relationships between opposing states grew increasingly tense, as well as the relationship between citizens and their respective governments. The United States' Marshall Plan was a post-war recovery initiative that invested billions of dollars in rehabilitation and rebuilding of Western Europe, while the USSR and its neighboring states suffered from economic instability and, in many nations, hyperinflation and poverty.

Proxy warfare is a military conflict that allows global superpowers to engage in combat without direct and expensive confrontation, and was used throughout the second half of the 21st century. Warfare in the Cold War consisted of battles puppeted primarily by the United States and the Soviet Union, and occurred in regions such as Korea, Vietnam, Afghanistan, and across Africa and Latin America. Sponsors desired to spread theoretical and political power throughout regions of existing conflict and tension, and involved themselves through providing military training, economic and weaponry aid, and occasionally direct military operations with the nation's own forces. While proxy wars allowed the United States and the USSR to engage in military combat with one another while gathering nuclear resources, external involvement often exploited and crippled local communities and exacerbated existing tensions. Engagement in proxy wars facilitated the emergence of political or military dictatorships, widened local military conflicts, and reduced the desire for surrogate countries to pursue diplomatic or peaceful negotiations. Consequences were largely dealt to civilians, who experienced famine, displacement, and devastation as a result of proxy wars.

The USSR and the United States displayed this political divide between capitalism and communism through instilling propaganda, igniting mutual suspicion and paranoia between their citizens. The mobilization of propaganda techniques is perhaps one of the most notable aspects of ideological warfare that occurred during the Cold War, as well as one of the most harmful. American and Soviet citizens were influenced by their respective political theories in everything from radio to magazines to movies.

The Early Nuclear and Space Race

Starting in the late 1940's, both the U.S. and the U.S.S.R competed over technological advancement and nuclear weaponry as a method of proving ideological superiority and maintaining mutually assured destruction.

In 1945, during World War II, The United States government, out of fear of a potential weapon of mass destruction being produced by Germany, began serious work on their nuclear weapons program with the Manhattan Project. The Manhattan project resulted in two bombs, Little Boy, a uranium bomb, and Fat Man, a plutonium bomb. Those bombs would be used later the same year to bomb Japan. Stalin viewed the U.S nuclear weapons program as an indirect attack on the Soviet Union, claiming that the bomb would give the U.S too great of an advantage in the post-war world. As a response to this, the soviet nuclear program was hastened and the first nuclear test by the U.S.S.R was conducted in August of 1949, three years before anticipated U.S spies. The possession of a weapon of mass destruction by both major players in the cold war introduced two related concepts, the first being Mutually Assured Destruction (MAD) and the second being a nuclear arms race. MAD as a theory outlines that if two opposing sides in a war have the option to completely destroy the other, along with the knowledge that both sides have

that power, neither side would actually use it and risk total destruction. The nuclear arms race was a means to maintain MAD as both the U.S and U.S.S.R attempted to have a stronger bomb than each other, resulting in both forces having approximately equal nuclear power. In 1952 and 1955, the U.S and U.S.S.R respectively tested their first hydrogen bomb, which was more powerful by far than the earlier uranium bombs. It is also important to note that outside of intentional harm done, the testing of atomic bombs caused severe and long-lasting damage to the communities surrounding test sites. Throughout the 50's, nuclear testing ramped up and was used both to test new nuclear technology and as an intimidation tactic. While MAD prevented the commonplace use of nuclear weaponry in war, testing was a method of making other nations aware of the nuclear capabilities in a given nation.

During and immediately after World War II, rocketry for use within and beyond the atmosphere was heavily invested in. Project Overcast, more commonly known as Operation Paperclip, involved the use of German scientists, including members of the Nazi party, by the U.S. government in order to adapt and develop technology used by Germany which took place in the later years of the war and continued into the space race. The culmination of Project Overcast was the launch of several V-2 rockets. The U.S.S.R responded with their own rocketry projects and the early focus of rocketry in the cold war was guided missiles, contributing to the nuclear arms race. Another method of developing aerospace technology was through investment in high-speed aircraft. In 1953, the first American super-sonic aircraft flew, paving the way for future high-speed planes. Like with the development of missiles and nuclear weaponry, the U.S.S.R and the U.S. competed to build the fastest, the most powerful, and the least detectable aircraft throughout the cold war. The most famous example of aerospace engineering in the cold war, however, is undoubtedly the space race. In 1957, the U.S.S.R launched Sputnik and Sputnik

2, becoming the first nation to launch a man-made object into space and to launch life into space. The Soviet Union would go on to obtain many firsts in the early Space Race, however, in the mid-50's a definitive goal was set, landing on the moon, with the U.S. achieving that goal first.

Competing Culture, Paranoia, and Propaganda

During the Cold War, culture and influence wars between democratic capitalist and authoritarian communist states are often considered as historically significant as any battle that occurred on ground. Although geographically separated by land and oceans, American and Soviet citizens experienced similar governmental influence on various forms of media. Furthermore, propaganda instilled a sense of nationalism in communities. Civilians were taught that their own country was the pinnacle of human excellence, and criticism of the government or their respective political ideology was not only unpatriotic, but treasonous.

In the Soviet Union, civilians faced famine and lack of individual rights, as well as a looming sense of paranoia. Propaganda was theorized as a form of education, deepening the sense of government control for USSR citizens. Support for proletarian internationalism and anti-capitalism was ingrained in Soviet youth from an early age through the popularization of youth organizations and political shrines in schools. Children and teens were trained to unconditionally support the Red state and the communist revolution, even if that support meant denouncing family and friends as pro-capitalist "kulaks" to the secret police NKVD. This environment of mutual suspicion and unconditional positive regard towards the government was strengthened through political cartoons, posters, and, during World War II, the national tours "propaganda trains" took across the Soviet Union. These propaganda trains carried lecturers,

mobile cinemas, and printing presses, and aimed to indoctrinate remote areas to the communist way of life.

In the United States, the government intensified anti-communist fear through a movement called the Red Scare, which occurred in two main periods. The First Red Scare occurred in 1917, and was sparked when Vladimir Lenin and his Bolshevik party initially overthrew the Russian Provisional Government and the Romanov dynasty. The rise of the proletariat party in Russia inspired labor strikes in the United States, while the government passed The Sedition Act of 1918 to criminalize criticism of the government and suppress rising labor movement. This period was intensified by a series of anarchist bombings and, subsequently, thousands of arrests of suspected radicals and communists. The Second Red Scare is historically associated with the late 1940s and 1950s, but began when the United States Congress formed the House Un-American Activities Committee (HUAC) in 1938. Under director John Edgar Hoover's Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI), legislative investigations into alleged communist activities occurred, sparking hysteria and growing conservatism among American citizens. This political practice and persecution is known as McCarthyism. Propaganda fueled and justified the actions of the American people and government, through similar methods like the Soviet Union's political cartoons and other forms of media. One example of anti-Soviet American propaganda during the Cold War was the 1950 United States Armed Force's educational film, titled *How to Spot a Communist*. Indications of alleged communist - and, fundamentally, un-American - involvement included criticism of capitalism, support of socialist beliefs ("Marxist jargon"), and belonging to certain groups. The typecasting and paranoia instilled in American citizens caused further cultural and ideological divide.

One of the largest alleged cases of political interference in free media was the large-scale Central Intelligence Agency (CIA) involvement in the American press during the civil war, known as Operation Mockingbird. From the 1960s onwards, evidence was released that Project Mockingbird was a government-sanctioned series of identifications, bribery, convictions, and covert operations that manipulated journalists and columnists, and defied the American constitutional right to free press. Throughout the Cold War, several allegations were targeted towards the CIA, claiming that the federal agency had violated its order by establishing relationships with private press organizations and institutions. Although the notion that the CIA's operations were deliberate, systematic, and malicious is unverified and widely considered conspiracist, whistleblowers throughout the 1960s and 1970s supported claims the agency attempted to influence public opinion.

Current State

For this committee, we will be starting in the year 1950. At this point in history, the first round of friendly and unfriendly witnesses have been called before HUAC and the FBI has been working with HUAC for 3 years to develop profiles on figures in Hollywood. The remaining witnesses and members of Hollywood that would later be subpoenaed by HUAC had already been pressured by the red scare as a whole.

Character List

Jean Muir - Jean Muir was a prominent actress in the 1940s. Outside of her acting roles, she was known for advocating against racism in Hollywood and for promoting acting unions. After being named in a report of actors and other members of Hollywood that allegedly had connections with the communist party, Muir was blacklisted from acting roles. Her career never fully recovered after her blacklisting and she eventually started teaching.

Edward Dmytryk - Edward Dmytryk was a successful director and a member of the Hollywood 10, a group of actors, writers, and directors who refused to testify before HUAC. He had been briefly associated with the communist party in America in the 1940s before separating from the party in 1945. He was subpoenaed to testify in 1947 on his affiliations with the communist party, but moved to England until his eventual arrest in 1951. Six months after his arrest, after being blacklisted, he testified before congress.

Dorothy Comingore - Comingore was a prominent actress in the 40s with her biggest role being in Citizen Kane. Due to her calls for desegregation, her advocacy for unions in Hollywood, and her marriage to a member of the communist party at the time, she was blacklisted by HUAC but not called upon immediately. In 1952 Comingore testified before HUAC, but her career never recovered after her initial blacklisting.

John Howard Lawson - J Howard Lawson was a very active writer in Hollywood in the 30s and 40s. He was President and a co-founder of the Screen Actor's Guild in the 30s and was a prominent member of the communist party at the time. In 1947 he was brought before HUAC for

his connections with the communist party. He refused to testify, leading to him being completely blacklisted and imprisoned.

John Edgar Hoover - J Edgar Hoover was the director of the FBI during the 30s and 40s, with the FBI collecting information on much of Hollywood at the time. He believed that communism was a danger to the American public, especially if communist ideals were spread through films and TV, and therefore was in favor of HUAC calling alleged communists to testify. The FBI's investigations were not limited to actual members of the communist party, but instead were broadened to those suspicious of anti-communist measures and those who advocated for economic or political reform.

John Henry Faulk - John Henry Faulk was a radio host in the 40s and 50s. In 1955, Faulk, who was a member of a union at the time, was blacklisted by a for-profit third-party organization, AWARE.inc. Faulk sued the organization and would eventually win in 1962.

Dalton Trumbo - Trumbo was a prominent screenwriter in the 40s and a communist party member for a brief stretch. In 1947, he was called to testify before HUAC and refused to do so out of a belief that being called to testify on his political beliefs was against his first amendment rights and out of a loyalty to his friends in Hollywood. While Trumbo did manage to continue a career in screenwriting, his career never fully recovered.

Ronald Reagan - Reagan, who was an actor and member of the board of directors for the Screen Actor's Guild at the time, was considered a friendly witness to HUAC. He was called to testify to condemn the actions and beliefs of others instead of defend his own, to which he obliged.

John Parnell Thomas - J Parnell Thomas was chairman of the House Un-American Activities Committee, in charge of calling members of the public to testify and hearing their testimony. Being the chairman, he led the calling of 19 members of Hollywood to testify and led the response to the Hollywood 10.

John S. Wood - John Wood was a member of the House Un-American Activities Committee. He called friendly and unfriendly witnesses in order to find and blacklist potential communist sympathizers in Hollywood, believing that their influence would harm the American public.

Lena Horne - Lena Horne was a performer, starting in the late 1910s at the Cotton Club. She was outspoken on issues of racial equality and continued to perform on stage and in film before being blacklisted in the 50s due to her connection with left-leaning political groups and her alleged communist connections. She continued to perform after the blacklist was lifted.

Walt Disney - Walt Disney testified before HUAC in 1947 as a friendly witness, outlining how communism affected his studio and naming several alleged communists. He argued to keep American Labor Unions clean of communist influences and urged HUAC to carry on with finding alleged communists and blocking them from working in Hollywood.

Questions to Consider

1. How far should the government's ability to investigate potential national security risks extend? At what point does a legitimate investigation become a violation of rights outlined in the constitution?
2. What is the potential impact of communist spies operating in the upper circles of Hollywood during the Cold War? How does propaganda at home affect the perception of foreign cultures and movements?
3. How might proxy wars in surrogate nations affect United States culture, media, and citizens? Do entertainers have the right to criticize the government and comment on social and political issues?

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